



Stems, the new audio format

Native Instruments is working on a new open file format called 'Stems' useful for creative mixing and DJing. Read here <http://dgit.in/offstems>



Minecraft Gameband

Bored of your usual bands? Check this new Minecraft Gameband Redstone here: <http://dgit.in/minecrafterable>

Feature

Similarly, electronic pocket translators let you conveniently translate innumerable number of languages, feature an in-built spell checker, grammar guide and audio to help accurately pronounce words. The biggest advantage of these devices and Google Translate is that they don't need an internet connection to function. Optical character recognition and translation software on mobiles devices instantly work together when you point your camera at foreign language text such as menus or signboards. India, however, is a different beast!

There's an Indian proverb that goes: "Every two miles the water doth change and every fourth, the dialect." Every 500 kilometers or so we have a new language, in whichever direction you go. It's not just completely different languages, there are also multiple dialects to each language, or a total of 1,653 dialects in the country. For travelers, and those looking to do business across the country, being able to flawlessly converse with locals is imperative – even a slight change in pronunciation can sometimes drastically alter the meaning of your sentence. Also, knowledge of the language breaks down barriers and helps learn about other cultures and communities better. Knowing or attempting to learn the local language shows respect towards the other's culture – always desirable.

Although we have dedicated software and web-based resources to translate to and from popular Indian languages, these are impractical for when you're on the go. What we need is a portable universal translator, which has long been a fixture of sci-fi, for the hundreds of purely Indian languages, or, well, the Babelfish.

3 Easier digital payments

Those of you who have travelled to Australia in the last few years will have seen people use Visa payWave. It's almost magical an experience when you first see it. If you're in line to pay at a grocery store, you'll see people walk up to the counter, goods are scanned super fast, and then someone waves their wallet in front of a scanner and walks out. It's even faster if you have just one item – you can hold it up to the cashier as you approach the till, the amount is already punched in and



NFC Payments

displayed as you pass the scanner, and in essence you just walk straight out of the door! No signing, no PINs, nothing!

Now in India, perhaps there are security risks that we'd want to protect against for such a system, but we certainly need to cut down on the amount of cold cash being circulated – to reduce corruption, for starters.

India is no stranger to this technology. Pre-paid NFC cards have been used for toll and transport in buses and the metro here for some time now. Recently, banks such as ICICI introduced credit and debit cards with the NFC feature incorporated in them. Axis and HDFC are expected to install around 50,000 and 20,000 PoS machines, respectively by the end of 2015. Earlier, the RBI has restricted the maximum amount per transaction to Rs

2,000 due to security concerns. This limit has now been lifted due to the inconvenience caused by the previously enforced rule, defeating the very purpose of the cards. Thankfully we're never far behind the world when it comes to banking, so we can hope for this to come in pretty soon.

4 Superfast trains

The fastest train in India is currently the Bhopal Shatabdi Express, whose peak speed is recorded as 150 km/h. The upcoming Gatimaan Express clocked a maximum speed of 160-plus km/h in its feasibility tests. The Japanese Shinkansen, however, AKA the "bullet train", travels at a speed of 320km/h. In April 2015, Japan's Maglev successfully completed its test run at 603 km/h. Maglev (magnetic levitation) trains



A high speed train in China